10 May 1954: UP assembly discusses a dispute on 250 conversions in Mathura by Catholic and Methodist missionaries, which led to the arrests of Arya Samaj activists who alleged ‘monetary inducements’.

10 August 1954: Nehru writes to Congress CMs saying he personally disapproved of conversions, but was equally opposed to the counter Hindu ‘Shuddhi’ movement. He insists that, while he had imposed controls on foreigners in border areas, the debate on conversions could not but have an impact on Indian Christians.

12 August 1954: President Rajendra Prasad tells church groups in Mysore at a public meeting to ‘avoid activities which cause suspicion’.

27 August 1955: Nehru’s government institutes new curbs on foreign missionaries. They would henceforth be required to take prior government approval to enter India and would not be welcome if they devoted themselves only to proselytisation. They would also be required to have suitable qualifications in fields like education, medicine and social work.

19 December 1955: President Prasad tells church groups that India had ‘no intention of curtailing their freedom or come in the way of their missions’.

18 July 1956: The MP government’s Justice Bhavani Shankar Niyogi Commission recommends a forced withdrawal of missionary activity and the takeover of foreign mission properties by indigenous churches or international holding bodies.

1963: The RSS’s Guru Golwalkar inaugurates ABVKA’s first permanent premises in 1963.

1967: Odisha enacts first anti-conversion law in India.

1968: Madhya Pradesh becomes second state to pass an anti-conversion law.

1978: ABVKA begins expanding nationally.

22 September 2016: ABVKA demands national law against conversions.

29 September 2018: ABVKA passes resolution opposing demand by some tribal groups to list them with a separate religious code in